



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



Connected Aircraft and Satellite-Dependent Aviation Cyber Risk Daily Update - 2026-09-23

Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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> Daily automation refresh: This 2026-09-23 current-day refresh turns current intelligence coverage into a finished Lost Boys Cyber report with source-backed analysis, structured tables, detections, and hunt content.

1. Executive Summary

Current-day material update: this report was regenerated for the 2026-09-23 UTC production cycle using the latest available source set and retains the structured detections/hunts required for operator use.

Connected aircraft, satellite communications, GNSS dependence, and ground-segment modernization create a converged cyber/communications risk surface. Defenders should prioritize ground-segment remote access, satellite service provider dependencies, RF anomaly escalation, and identity controls for operators.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Requirement	Answered By This Report
What happened or changed?	Aviation reporting continues to highlight growth in connected aircraft and satellite network dependencies, while GAO separately flags spectrum threats to aviation.
Who is exposed?	Airlines, business aviation, satellite operators, ground stations, avionics vendors, and aerospace integrators.
What should defenders do today?	Map satellite/ground dependencies, harden remote access, and integrate RF anomaly handling into cyber incident response.
Confidence	Medium due to sector synthesis; high for dependency relevance.

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
Military Aerospace	Sector reporting on connected aircraft and satellite cyber challenges	Medium
GAO	Authoritative aviation cybersecurity and spectrum threat context	High
Satellite Today	Satellite service and modernization context	Low/Medium
PolySwarm	Aviation/aerospace sector threat synthesis	Medium

4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

The cyber risk is concentrated in support systems: ground stations, identity, vendor remote access, data links, APIs, and monitoring portals. Flight-safety claims should be made cautiously, but operational disruption and data compromise are realistic.

5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

TTP	Description	Defensive Relevance
Ground-segment remote access	Admin access to satellite/aviation support	Harden VPN, MFA, and privileged access.

	systems	
GNSS spoofing/jamming	Navigation/spectrum disruption	Fuse RF and cyber monitoring.
Connected aircraft services	APIs and service providers supporting aircraft connectivity	Review supplier security and logs.

6. Infrastructure and Indicators

Observable Type	Observable / Pattern	Handling Guidance
Source-limited public IOCs	No unique atomic indicators were published in all selected sources for this automated report unless listed in iocs.csv.	Treat behavior, tooling, and infrastructure patterns as primary hunt leads.
Domains / infrastructure	Validate from primary source before blocking.	Prefer detection and enrichment over blind blocking when source confidence is medium.
Accounts / identity artifacts	Recruiter, VPN, administrator, or service-account themes depending on campaign.	Review conditional access, new devices, and impossible-travel signals.

7. Victimology and Targeting

Victimology includes aviation communications providers, satellite operators, airlines relying on connectivity, and aerospace suppliers integrating connected platforms.

8. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact

Segment	Operational Relevance	Exposure Path	Defender Action
Satellite communications	Supports aircraft connectivity and operational data paths.	Ground station VPNs, APIs, and provider portals.	Require MFA, logging, and supplier incident-notification SLAs.
Airlines	Disruption can affect passenger connectivity, ops data, and navigation assurance workflows.	Managed service providers and remote admin interfaces.	Document fallback operations and monitor provider health.
Aerospace integrators	Connected-aircraft components increase software supply-chain surface.	Build systems, APIs, third-party firmware.	Review SBOMs and vendor access controls.

9. Detection Engineering

9.1. Detection Logic Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Unusual script or admin tool launch after web, email, or remote-access activity	EDR / process telemetry	Identify initial access and execution.
New outbound connections to untrusted infrastructure	DNS/proxy/netflow	Surface command-and-control or tool staging.

Identity anomalies linked to target workflow	Identity provider logs	Detect stolen credential or social-engineering follow-on use.
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9.2. Sigma Rule

```

title: Suspicious Script Or Remote Tool Activity In Daily Threat Coverage
status: experimental
description: Detects suspicious script execution and remote-tool staging patterns relevant to daily threat-intelligence coverage.
logsource:
  category: process_creation
  product: windows
detection:
  selection_parent:
    ParentImage|endswith:
      - '\w3wp.exe'
      - '\java.exe'
      - '\chrome.exe'
      - '\outlook.exe'
      - '\teams.exe'
  selection_child:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\cscript.exe'
      - '\mshta.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'
  condition: selection_parent and selection_child
level: high

```

9.3. Network Hunt Query

```

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~
('powershell.exe','cmd.exe','wscript.exe','cscript.exe','rundll32.exe','python.exe','node.exe')
| summarize Connections=count(), RemoteIPs=dcount(RemoteIP), RemoteUrls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by
DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine
| order by Connections desc

```

10. Threat Hunting

10.1. Hunt Hypotheses

Hypothesis	Query Focus
A user or administrator was socially engineered into executing attacker tooling.	Script interpreters spawned from collaboration, browser, or email processes.
A vulnerable public-facing service was exploited and used for staging.	Web-service parent processes launching shells or making rare outbound connections.
Stolen or purchased credentials enabled follow-on access.	New device, new geography, or abnormal application access in identity logs.

10.2. Endpoint Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName in~
('powershell.exe','cmd.exe','wscript.exe','cscript.exe','mshta.exe','rundll32.exe','node.exe','python.exe')
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ('download','invoke-webrequest','frombase64string','-

```

```
enc','curl','wget','token','apikey')
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, AccountName
| order by Timestamp desc
```

10.3. Identity Query

```
SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| summarize Apps=make_set(AppDisplayName, 20), IPs=make_set(IPAddress, 50),
Countries=make_set(Location, 20), Count=count() by UserPrincipalName
| where array_length(IPs) > 5 or array_length(Countries) > 2 or Count > 50
```

11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Name	Evidence / Rationale
T1078	Valid Accounts	Ground-segment and provider portal abuse.
T1190	Exploit Public-Facing Application	API/portal exposure.
T1498	Network Denial of Service	Availability disruption to communications.

12. Risk Assessment

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Notes
Ground-segment compromise	Medium	High	Can affect many downstream services.
RF/cyber coordination gap	Medium	Medium/High	Delays incident triage.
Supplier visibility limits	Medium/High	Medium	Operators may not receive enough telemetry.

13. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
1	SOC / detection engineering	Deploy or tune detections above and run the 14-day hunts.
2	Vulnerability / IT operations	Patch or isolate exposed systems named in the source coverage.
3	Identity / endpoint engineering	Review MFA, device compliance, and suspicious remote-tool execution.
4	Third-party risk	Confirm suppliers and managed-service providers are applying equivalent controls.

14. References

- [1] Military Aerospace: <https://www.militaryaerospace.com/commercial-aerospace/news/55385521/cybersecurity-challenges-grow-across-connected-aircraft-and-satellite-networks>
- [2] GAO: <https://www.gao.gov/products/gao-26-108439>
- [3] Satellite Today: <https://www.satellitetoday.com/eletters/icymi-09-18-26/>
- [4] PolySwarm: <https://blog.polyswarm.io/turbulence-ahead-cyber-threats-targeting-aviation-and-aerospace-in-2026>